acknowledgments

You and I have something in common: I also read everything in a book, including the acknowledgments. As a reader, I'd always wondered just how much the author was expected to say—and how much was genuine. Now that I find myself writing my own acknowledgments section, I find myself at a loss: How do I properly express gratitude to all those deserving?

Cliche as it may be, I'll start with my wife. She had unwavering enthusiasm throughout this project and confidence when mine was waning. Her support means everything to me. I'm a very lucky man.

Although my parents think Python has something to do with slithering animals, I'm still grateful for everything they have provided me. Whether nature or nurture, they can take more credit than most.

Before starting on this journey, I was ignorant of the fact that the term "editor" actually refers to a collective. Michael Stephens is my procurement editor, which means he was responsible for challenging me with doing this in the first place. Without him, none of this would have got started. Connor O'Brien is my development editor; he's what you think of when you hear the word "editor." He was my first reader, my guide, and a very patient man. He agreed to sign on when things were rough, at the beginning, and I'm grateful he took the chance on me. Thank you, Connor; it wouldn't have gotten done without you. And to complete the triumvirate, is Christian Berk, my copy editor, making me sound far more literate than I am. He diligently replaced every "which" with "that" and vice versa—I never seem to get those right.

To fellow Manning author (that's fun to write) and Real Python alumni, Dane Hillard, thanks for lending me your setup, saving me days of technical work, and listening to my moaning. Your perspective was invaluable.